

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: 2015 origin, legal status and power boundary

1 JANUARY 2015 -> Union Cabinet resolution creates NITI Aayog

STATUS -> executive + non-constitutional + non-statutory

ROLE -> advise, convene, strategise, monitor and support capacity

NO OWN POWER -> legislate, tax, allocate divisible pool or impose State plans

LIMIT: recommendation becomes action only through competent government authority.

MUST REMEMBER: NITI Aayog is an executive, non-constitutional and non-statutory policy platform created by the Cabinet resolution of 1 January 2015.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Mandate: think, convene and learn

THINK -> strategy, policy research and knowledge networks

CONVENE -> Union-State dialogue and inter-sector coordination

LEARN -> monitoring, evaluation, feedback and adaptation

FOUNDATION -> shared vision + bottom-up plans + vulnerable groups + technology

TRAP: an official objective is a mandate, not evidence of achieved outcomes.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Composition and notification-sensitive roles

CHAIRPERSON -> Prime Minister

GOVERNING COUNCIL -> State CMs + relevant UT leadership

EXPERT SIDE -> Vice-Chairperson + full-time and part-time members

UNION LINK -> ex-officio Ministers + special invitees

ADMINISTRATION -> CEO

CONTROL: names, portfolios and invitees require a dated official notification.

LATEST FORMAL ROSTER: 24 APRIL 2026

Vice Chairperson: Ashok Kumar Lahiri.

Full-time: Rajiv Gauba | K. V. Raju | Gobardhan Das
| Abhay Karandikar | M. Srinivas.

Ex-officio members and special invitees remain those in the 16 July 2024 notice.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Governing Council and Regional Councils

GOVERNING COUNCIL -> continuing PM-chaired development-policy forum

MEMBERS -> State and UT political leadership under current constitution/order

REGIONAL COUNCIL -> temporary, issue-specific, multi-State or regional mechanism

PROCESS -> agenda -> joint diagnosis -> consultation -> agreed follow-up

LIMIT: consensus is political coordination, not binding law or a State veto.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Planning Commission transition

CONTINUITY -> both bodies arose through executive resolution

PLANNING COMMISSION -> Five-Year Plans + plan-resource influence + central negotiation

NITI -> indicative strategy + federal dialogue + monitoring + knowledge

LATER REFORM -> plan/non-plan budget distinction ended separately

VERDICT: directive allocation shifted toward advisory coordination and softer leverage.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Cooperative and competitive federalism

COOPERATIVE -> shared agenda + State voice + joint problem-solving + capacity support

COMPETITIVE -> common indicator -> comparison -> reputation -> administrative response

STATE SUPPORT -> policy and institutional capability partnerships

RISKS -> central agenda power + boycott/non-attendance + unequal capacity + data gaming

BALANCE: participation improves legitimacy only when evidence and follow-up are credible.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Advice, convening, monitoring and rankings do not confer legislative, taxing, devolution, fund-allocation or implementation powers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Evidence, indicators and evaluation

OUTCOME -> indicator -> baseline -> verified data -> comparison
-> diagnosis -> intervention -> reassessment

DME0 -> monitoring and evaluation support

SAFE REPORTING -> rank + absolute level + change + uncertainty + field evidence

TRAP: dashboard movement does not by itself establish causation or durable welfare gain.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Aspirational Districts and Blocks

CONVERGENCE -> align schemes and agencies

COLLABORATION -> Centre + State + district/block teams

COMPETITION -> delta indicators and peer comparison

DELIVERY -> remains with competent governments and field administration

LIMIT: NITI coordinates and monitors; it does not directly deliver every service.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: SDGs, DME0 and Atal Innovation Mission

SDG LOCALISATION -> goals -> indicators -> State/local attention

DME0 -> programme monitoring and evaluation

AIM -> innovation initiative under NITI; architecture is date-sensitive

PROGRAMME TEST -> owner + mechanism + implementer + evidence + limit

PYQ 2019: institutional ownership matters more than the programme name.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: NITI and neighbouring institutions

NITI -> executive strategy, dialogue and monitoring
FINANCE COMMISSION -> Article 280 fiscal recommendations
GST COUNCIL -> Article 279A GST recommendations
INTER-STATE COUNCIL -> Article 263 coordination route
ZONAL COUNCILS -> statutory regional cooperation
STATE FINANCE COMMISSIONS -> State-local fiscal recommendations

Never transfer one body's source or power to another.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Strengths, deficits and accountable reform

STRENGTHS -> flexibility + expertise + convening + cross-sector evidence

DEFICITS -> non-binding advice + central agenda + weak reporting + data risk

REFORM -> State agenda windows + published consultations + independent data audit

-> action tracking + parliamentary visibility + implementation feedback

GOAL: retain flexibility while making influence transparent and evaluable.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: PYQ routes and answer synthesis

PYQ 2018 -> NITI principles versus Planning Commission

PYQ 2019 -> Atal Innovation Mission institutional location

PRELIMS -> executive != unconstitutional | Council != legislature | index != power

MAINS -> origin -> mandate -> composition -> federal mechanism -> programme evidence
-> fiscal/data limits -> accountable reform -> qualified verdict

NITI succeeds through credible persuasion, State ownership and implementation.

LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: The 24 April 2026 Gazette replaced the Vice Chairperson and full-time member roster while retaining the July 2024 ex-officio members and invitees.